PROPOSALS

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Contesting for the Post of
General Secretary, Sports and Games
Technology Students' Gymkhana
Indian Institute of Technology, Kharagpur
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Proposal 1: Enhancing Accessibility and Utilization of Campus Sports Facilities

Objective:
To improve access to campus sports facilities through flexible slot booking, digital sports IDs for verified entry, and extended operating hours for indoor sports.

Current Scenario:

- The current slot booking system is only semester wise, which provides limited flexibility to students whose availability is not constant due to the nature of the academic workload.
- There are often booking conflicts, especially during peak hours when the demand for high demand facilities such as Badminton Courts and Table Tennis Rooms is high, but there is no mechanism in place to redistribute the unused slots.
- The current access control mechanism is based on manual verification, which results in inconsistencies and unauthorized access, thereby affecting the availability of the facilities.
- The Indoor Sports Facilities are closed in the late evenings, which results in students who prefer night time practice facing a shortage of options.
- There is no centralized digital identity mechanism in place, which results in difficulties in tracking the usage of the sports facilities.

Implementation:

- Development and implementation of a digital slot booking portal, which can be integrated with the Gymkhana website, for day and hour wise bookings with real time availability and conflict resolution.
- Issuance of digital sports IDs for all students, mapped to their respective roll numbers, to facilitate quick and secure entry through QR based scanning.
- Development of an admin panel for subcommittee coordinators to track bookings, detect abuses, and dynamically allocate unused slots.
- Formulation and submission of a proposal to extend the operational hours of Badminton and Table Tennis facilities till midnight.
- The proposal for the extension of the hours of the facilities will be taken up with the required approval of the administration.

Impact:

- Students with non traditional schedules will have equitable and accessible use of the facilities, thus increasing the usage rates.
- Unauthorized use will be minimized with digital verification to ensure that resources are available to legitimate users.

- Longer hours of use for indoor sports will be allocated to allow for student use in the evenings or late at night, thus increasing the number of sports participants.
- Decisions will be made based on information gathered to ensure that resources are allocated appropriately.

Groundwork:
These issues of booking conflicts and unauthorized access have been confirmed with the existing secretaries of the Sports and Games subcommittee and the facility attendants. Interacting with the students in the hostels has shown the need to extend the hours of the indoor facilities. The technical feasibility of developing a booking system and a system of ID cards using QR codes has been confirmed with the Technology Coordinators of the TSG.

Proposal 2: Improving Engagement and Experience in Shaurya

Objective:
To increase the reach and scope of Shaurya by conducting preliminary events in the partner colleges, with the best performing teams qualifying directly to the main event at IIT Kharagpur.

Current Scenario:

- The current reach and scope of Shaurya is only within the campus of IIT Kharagpur, and the participation is restricted to only those colleges and teams that are willing to spend on the travel costs, as the teams might only play preliminary fixtures in the main event.
- Overhauled the existing Campus Ambassador program and incorporated a merit based reward system. Increased engagement and digital presence through the development of website features and social media spotlights.
- Teams from colleges far away are likely to face difficulties and might not be interested in participating, as the cost and logistics would be high, and the awareness and popularity of Shaurya are still less, especially among the colleges and teams that are not part of the IIT and NIT circuit.
- The sponsors and brands are not fully aware of the reach and scope of Shaurya as an event, and this could be because the reach and scope are still confined to the campus of IIT Kharagpur.

Implementation:

- Partner colleges in the surrounding cities will be identified and approached to host the preliminary events. Agreements will be made with these colleges to host the events.
- Sponsors at the regional level and at the level of specific brands will be approached to provide financial support to the preliminary events. This will reduce the financial burden on the Gymkhana.
- A tiered qualification system will be developed. The top placed teams at the preliminary events will earn spots at the main event stages of Shaurya, while the remaining spots will be kept for teams to register directly.
- A shared coordination interface will be used to manage participant information, schedules, and results for all preliminary events.
- Promotion campaigns will be launched at the level of the partner colleges and sports communities on social media platforms.

Impact:

- Shaurya participant count and team diversity will also improve with the removal of the logistical hurdles for first round fixtures.

- Having a prelim circuit structure will help Shaurya attain a status of a truly national level event, overcoming the institutional boundaries.
- Sponsors from the regional areas will receive a more desirable partnership, providing a stronger chance for a sustainable model for event funding.
- Campus ambassador networks will enable Shaurya and future editions of Inter IIT to build relationships with other institutions.
- Prelim circuit engagement will help build hype for the main event, ensuring a greater turn out and media coverage.

Groundwork:
The current Shaurya organizing team has been consulted, and they are receptive to the idea of growing through a formalized system of a prelim. Initial talks with student representatives from local colleges in surrounding cities indicate a positive response to participating and/or hosting. Potential regional sponsors, such as sports gear and local F&B brands, have been identified as potential targets for sponsorship outreach. Promotion outreach will be conducted through a mix of social media, newsletters, blogs, and a formal proposal to ensure maximum visibility for each event prior to the start of the prelim event.

Proposal 3: Promoting Inclusive Fitness for Women

Objective:
To encourage women students to engage in physical activity through fitness and wellness programs, creating an inclusive and conducive sporting culture among women students.

Current Scenario:

- Women's participation in organized sports and fitness activities remains considerably lower than men's, with many citing lack of dedicated spaces and timing mismatches as key barriers.
- Existing fitness infrastructure is predominantly used by men, and women students often do not feel sufficiently comfortable accessing these spaces independently
- Currently, no fitness classes like aerobics, Zumba, etc., are being conducted under the umbrella of Sports and Games, especially during times convenient for women students.
- No workshops are being conducted on topics related to nutrition, recovery, and injury prevention, which are very important aspects of fitness and sporting activities.
- The lack of a supportive peer environment and visible female mentors in sports makes it more difficult for new participants to take the first step toward regular physical activity.

Implementation:

- Fitness classes on Zumba and aerobics would be conducted at timings determined through a survey of the students, with a focus on the morning and evening hours excluding the academic schedule.
- These classes would be conducted by certified instructors or experienced student volunteers, with the Gymkhana providing the required facilities.
- Workshops on nutrition, recovery, and prevention would also be conducted with the medical facilities of the Institute and Physical Training Instructors.
- These classes would be conducted with the aim of being open and non competitive and would emphasize the fact that they are open to students of all fitness levels.
- Women Inter IIT sportspersons and women sportspersons would be approached to promote the initiative and motivate the students to participate.
- Participation would be recorded and feedback would be taken after each session to improve the timings and topics of the events conducted in the future.

Impact:

- The regular participation in fitness sessions would help in maintaining the physical well being of women students and reduce stress levels during peak academic sessions.

- The fitness culture would encourage more women students to take part in competitive sporting events like Open IIT and General Championship.
- The workshops would help women students gain knowledge on various aspects of fitness, which would be beneficial for them even in the later stages of their life.
- This would mark a significant transformation in the culture of sports in IIT Kharagpur, promoting gender inclusivity.
- This initiative will foster a fitness community for female students, promoting mutual encouragement and increased participation.

Groundwork:
The need for fitness options, including time slots that are flexible to accommodate academic sessions, has been validated through conversations with the women students across the halls of residence. Discussions with the Gymkhana administration have validated the availability of venues for holding zumba and aerobics sessions. The possibility of bringing in instructors for these sessions on a regular basis has also been explored. The fitness programs offered at other IITs have also been studied to determine the formats that have been successful.

Proposal 4: Institutionalizing a Sustainable Talent Pipeline

Objective:
To ensure that no student misses their chance to play simply because of a clashing schedule. By moving from one off trials to a recurring weekend culture, we aim to create a welcoming environment where beginners can find their footing and senior players can leave a lasting legacy as certified mentors and scouts.

Current Scenario:

- Currently, workshops/trials for sports happen only once a year. For a student who has a conflicting lab session or an emergency, it means a whole year of sporting development down the drain.
- Many students feel intimidated to join existing teams in the middle of the semester without a proper point of entry. It leads to existing talent staying in their rooms instead of contributing to their respective Halls or even the Institute.
- Our senior players and Inter IIT athletes are the backbone of sports in IIT Kharagpur. They often spend hours of their own time unofficially coaching young students, but this invaluable service remains unrecorded and unrewarded by the Gymkhana.
- PTIs and senior players face difficulties in scouting for new talent after the initial NSO window, leading to a lesser talent pool for the General Championship and Inter IIT meets.

Implementation:

- A one-month block will be designated in the Autumn semester and another in the Spring semester for recurring weekend workshops.
- The workshops would be conducted every weekend for these months. This would act as a safety net, and if a student is busy one weekend, he/she would still have three other opportunities to participate and learn.
- Senior players will be officially appointed as Student Coaches. This elevates their role from informal helpers to recognized leaders of the sports community.
- To reward these players for their commitment, a Gymkhana Certificate of Coaching Excellence would be given to all the Student Coaches. This would give these players a formal certificate for their leadership and coaching abilities.

Impact:

- By making workshops a regular occurrence, we reduce the barrier for entry for newbies, keeping sports an environment where all students feel welcome, regardless of skill level.
- The student coach concept provides a tangible reward for our senior athletes' commitment of time, creating an environment where giving back is part of who they are.

- An observation window of a month allows senior captains to identify bloomers who may have missed NSO trials but have the grit and potential to shine in high stakes competitions.
- Dismantling the barriers between senior experts and junior newcomers through weekend play fosters stronger batch ties and a more healthy, active campus lifestyle.

Groundwork:
A preliminary review of the academic calendar suggests that four-week workshops can be smoothly incorporated without interfering with the mid-semester and end-semester examination schedules. Consultations with several Inter IIT captains have revealed an overwhelming enthusiasm to conduct these workshops, provided they are given recognition and an opportunity to find new players for their respective teams. Consultations with the Physical Training Instructors (PTIs) reveal that the facilities can be booked in the specified weekend slots at the beginning of each semester.